

Immune system activity reduced
In the moment, dealing with infections is not crucial, so the immune system shuts down to save energy.



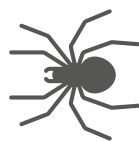
Blood sugar spikes
Sugar stores are released from the liver to provide the muscles with the energy they need to work. Fat stores are also mobilized.



Blood flows to muscles
Blood carries nutrients and the oxygen to the muscles, readying them to fight or flee from danger.



Bladder muscles relax
This causes us to need to urinate, which rids the body of excess weight and makes us faster and lighter.



4 PERCENT OF PEOPLE WORLDWIDE HAVE ARACHNOPHOBIA, A FEAR OF SPIDERS

Angry or afraid?

The bodily reactions to fear and anger are similar. It is mainly the way we interpret the sensations we experience that determines whether we feel afraid or angry. One theory suggests that if we know why a negative event happened, and who was responsible for it, we will feel angry. If we are unable to figure out the cause, or it is out of our control, we will feel fear.

Context is key

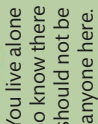
Whether we react with fear or anger to a particular stimulus is often conditioned by its context.



You are woken by loud noises downstairs in the middle of the night.



Fight-or-flight reflex is triggered



You live alone so know there should not be anyone here.



You live alone so know there should not be anyone here.



Without being able to figure out the cause, you feel afraid.

YOU LIVE ALONE



Sensations are interpreted as anger about inconsiderate behavior.



You recall your roommate was out and realize she has come back.

LIVE WITH ROOMMATE

Panic attacks

Panic attacks are physical reactions to fear or anxiety. Symptoms include a pounding heart; chest pain; rapid, shallow breathing; and sweating. Initially, sufferers can think they are having a heart attack. The first step to break the cycle is to recognize that you are experiencing a panic attack.

